

Festive tech fiesta?

A fool's errand

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

Ah, my dears, brace yourselves, for it's that time of the year again – the grand sale season, where consumers are lured into the irresistible world of discounts and deals. Every year, without fail, this extravagant circus arrives, and without fail, hordes of people rush to empty their pockets for the latest gadgets. But let me be the harbinger of sobriety in this mad frenzy, as I, Boo-Man, urge you to think twice before you succumb to the temptation of the techsplurge.

First and foremost, let's talk about these grand sales and their promises. Oh, they do know how to dazzle us with their extravagant banners, promising discounts that seem to defy the laws of mathematics. But have you ever noticed that the prices seem to be inflated just before the sale? It's like a magician's trick, making you believe that you're saving a fortune, when in reality, you're just spending what you would have spent anyway.

And let's not forget the glorious cash-back offers and no-cost EMI schemes. They make it sound like you're getting a deal of a lifetime. But, in reality, you're just locking yourself into a labyrinth of payments that could haunt your bank account for months, if not years. No-cost EMI? Well, my friend, there's no such thing as a free lunch. It's just a clever way to disguise the true cost of your shiny new gadget.

Now, onto the gadgets themselves. Yes, they're shiny, sleek, and come with an overwhelming list of features that can make even the most stoic individual drool. But do you really need that new smartphone with a camera that has more megapixels than you



can count? Are you sure your life will be incomplete without the latest gaming console or smartwatch? It's time to ponder the eternal question: Are you the master of your gadgets, or are they the master of you?

Let's not forget the tech companies and their clever marketing tactics. They make it seem like you're missing out on life if you don't own the latest gizmo. FOMO, they call it. Fear of Missing Out. But let me tell you, it's just a fear they've manufactured to make you part with your hard-earned money. They'll make you believe that your current device is obsolete, even if it's just a few months old.

The good old days of tech, when a device served its purpose without needing an update every few months, are long gone. Now, it's all about planned obsolescence and the perpetual race to own the newest, flashiest thing. Is this really progress, or are we just spinning our wheels, adding to the mountains of e-waste that already plague our beautiful country?

So, as you contemplate your techsplurge this season, remember that there's a fine line between being a tech

enthusiast and being a tech addict. It's time to take a step back, evaluate your real needs, and think twice before you join the mindless rush to buy what the tech giants want you to buy.

Furthermore, let's not forget the ongoing costs of tech ownership. The shiny gadgets themselves are just the tip of the iceberg. Every device you acquire comes with hidden expenses, like the never-ending software updates that gobble up your data, not to mention the constant need for accessories,

warranties, and technical support. These are costs that quietly pile up, eating away at your finances like termites in the woodwork.

And what about the environmental impact of our techsplurge? India is already grappling with a growing e-waste problem, with mountains of discarded devices that harm our environment and human health. Do we really want to contribute to this predicament by perpetually upgrading our gadgets without considering the consequences?

It's high time. Let's be discerning consumers who buy what we genuinely need, not what advertisers dictate. Remember, the best tech is not necessarily the newest tech. In fact, older, well-maintained devices can often serve you just as well while saving both your money and the environment.

So, my dear fans, don't let the siren call of the sale season lead you astray. Reevaluate your tech priorities, practice restraint, and make informed decisions that align with your actual needs. Boo-Man may be a cynic, but sometimes a little cynicism can help us see through the hype and make choices that are truly in our best interests. **d**